

Updatechecker is incredibly easy to use, but doesn't recognise that many applications, so it's a good idea to install at least one more update manager to offer a second opinion. Updatestar ([www.updatestar.com](http://www.updatestar.com)) maintains a database of over 80,000 application versions and is probably the best choice, although Sumo ([www.kcsoftwares.com/?sumo](http://www.kcsoftwares.com/?sumo)) is a close second and Secunia PSI (<http://psi.secunia.com>) is excellent at warning you about security patches that you really should have installed. Try them all, see which one works out best for you.

### Fix almost anything

Windows Vista has plenty of flaws, then, but it's still the best version of Windows yet. And it has one very significant advantage over Linux and Leopard — its large user base. Most people choose to install Windows on their desktops, and so that's where software developers focus their attention. As a result there are far more services, tools and add-ons available for Windows than any other operating system, more than enough to solve just about any Windows problem.

So if you're frustrated by some aspect of Vista, the chances are it can be fixed. Tired of Windows' feeble CD-burning features? Install Burnaware Free ([www.burnaware.com/burnaware\\_free.html](http://www.burnaware.com/burnaware_free.html)). Annoyed you need to access your PC across the internet, but Remote Desktop isn't included with Windows Vista Home Premium? Use Logmein instead ([www.logmein.com](http://www.logmein.com)). Need a more powerful Media Player that doesn't use all your system resources? Try VLC ([www.videolan.org/vlc](http://www.videolan.org/vlc)). Check out the applications on our cover disc for more ideas, install free tools from software libraries like Snapfiles ([www.snapfiles.com](http://www.snapfiles.com)) or Freeware Home (<http://freeware-home.com>) and get Windows working just the way you would like.